

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 158

By Pody

A RESOLUTION to honor B.J. Keener, Executive Director of
Donelson-Hermitage Family YMCA.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should salute those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy individual is B.J. Keener, who has admirably served as Executive Director of Donelson-Hermitage Family YMCA for the past ten years; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Keener began her illustrious tenure with YMCA of Middle Tennessee in 2007 as a wellness specialist and personal trainer at Mount Juliet YMCA and advanced to the position of Wellness Director at Donelson-Hermitage Family YMCA in 2008; and

WHEREAS, in 2010, she became Operations Executive for Donelson-Hermitage Family YMCA and Oakwood Commons YMCA, in which capacity she oversaw daily operations at two facilities and concurrently worked with thirteen other branches to strengthen wellness appointment processes; and

WHEREAS, B.J. Keener accepted the position of Executive Director of Donelson-Hermitage Family YMCA of Middle Tennessee in 2014, in which capacity she is responsible for the operational management of the top-tier branch with more than 13,000 members; in 2016, she oversaw a 9,000-square-foot renovation and expansion of the facility; and

WHEREAS, a dedicated professional, Ms. Keener supports the YMT Movement by providing task-force input on risk management, organizational governance, personal training, and programming, and she is a mentor for the Trailblazers program and an executive sponsor of the Women's Leadership Resource Network; and

WHEREAS, B.J. Keener holds a Bachelor of Science degree in Psychology as well as Y-USA certifications, 360 Coach certification, and faculty certification as an organizational leader; in 2015, she completed training at the New Branch Executive Institute; and

WHEREAS, a lifelong fitness fanatic, Ms. Keener has been leading and coaching others in fitness since 1994, including personal training, for which she is actively certified as an American College of Sports Medicine personal trainer, group fitness trainer, and YogaFit trainer; she is also on track to complete her registered yoga teacher certification by the end of 2025; and

WHEREAS, dedicated to serving her community, B.J. Keener is a member of the board of directors of the Donelson-Hermitage Chamber of Commerce, of which she has been a member since 2014; she joined Women in Business in 2016, which she currently serves as chair; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Keener is a L'Evate Business Class graduate; she has served the organization as a member of the scholarship committee, as co-chair of the program committee, and, since 2016, as a board participant; and

WHEREAS, a 2019 recipient of the Heart of Donelson Award, B.J. Keener has been a Tennessee Beer Wine & Shine Festival volunteer since 2011 and has served as its volunteer coordinator for the past five years; annual proceeds from the popular festival provide financial assistance to many local charities and organizations; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Keener has demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity as Executive Director of Donelson-Hermitage Family YMCA, winning the unbridled respect and admiration of her colleagues and community alike; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to pause in our deliberations to acknowledge and applaud B.J. Keener for her dedication to the State of Tennessee and its citizens; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend B.J. Keener on her successful tenure as Executive Director of Donelson-Hermitage Family YMCA and extend to her our best wishes for every continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.